

AI LEGAL™

Firm Case Delegation & Pipeline Management System

Multi-Advocate Case Allocation • Lead Counsel Protection • Collaborative Dockets • Task Governance

Document Area	Details
Primary System	AI LEGAL™ Firm Case Delegation & Pipeline Management
Core Functions	Case allocation, team management, lead counsel protection, collaborative case folders and task delegation
Primary Users	Managing Partners, Lead Advocates, Associates, Researchers, Paralegals and Court Clerks
Architecture	Workspace → Cases → Team Members → Drafts / Evidence / Hearings / Tasks

AI LEGAL — Firm Case Delegation & Pipeline Management System

Multi-Advocate Case Allocation, Lead Counsel Protection, Collaborative Dockets & Task Governance

1. Executive Summary & Core Objective

In an active litigation practice or corporate law firm, cases are rarely handled by a single lawyer in isolation. A complex High Court commercial suit or criminal trial involves a `\\Lead Senior Counsel\\` who argues in court, an `\\Associate Advocate\\` who drafts the petitions and manages interim applications, a `\\Legal Researcher\\` who finds favorable case laws and citations, and a `\\Paralegal\\` who organizes evidence exhibits and tracks registry cause lists.

The `\\AI LEGAL Firm Case Delegation & Pipeline Management System\\` introduces an intelligent, permission-aware delegation framework:

- `\\Explicit Lead Counsel Ownership (\\leadAdvocate\\ / \\leadAdvocateUserId):\\` Every case has a primary attorney accountable for legal strategy and court submissions.
- `\\Multi-Advocate Team Roster (\\teamMembers\\ / \\assignedUserIds):\\` Dynamic association of associates, researchers, and paralegals to specific case dockets.
- `\\Lead Advocate Protection Rules:\\` Prevents accidental removal or orphaning of cases by enforcing formal succession or transfer protocols.
- `\\Collaborative Case Folders:\\` Shared digital workspaces uniting pleadings, evidentiary dockets, AI case predictions, research notes, and hearing logs with role-based read/write access.
- `\\Granular Task Delegation Pipeline:\\` Assignment of discrete legal action items (drafting rejoinders, serving notices, inspecting records) with real-time deadline tracking.

2. Technical Data Architecture & Case Schema

`\\mermaid`

`erDiagram`

`WORKSPACE ||--o{ PROJECTCASE : "contains"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--|| USERLEAD : "has leadAdvocate (Primary Counsel)"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--o{ CASETEAMMEMBER : "has assigned team members"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--o{ CASEDRAFT : "contains pleadings & drafts"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--o{ CASEEVIDENCE : "contains evidentiary exhibits"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--o{ CASEHEARING : "tracks court appearances"`

`PROJECTCASE ||--o{ CASETASK : "delegates action items"`

`PROJECTCASE {`

`ObjectId \\id`

`ObjectId workspaceId`

`string name`

`string caseType`

`string clientName`

`string leadAdvocate`

`ObjectId leadAdvocateUserId`

`Array teamMembers`

`Array assignedUserIds`

`string status`

`string stage`

`}`

\\\

Key Schema Fields in \models/Project.js:

- \workspaceId: Points to the parent Law Firm Workspace (\Workspace.\id).
- \leadAdvocate: Formal name of the primary lawyer (e.g., \Adv. Rajesh Sharma").
- \leadAdvocateUserId: MongoDB \ObjectId\ referencing the lead advocate's user document.
- \teamMembers: Array of objects or member names actively collaborating on this case.
- \assignedUserIds: Array of User IDs permitted to view, edit, and receive notifications for this case.
- \stage: Current litigation stage (\Pre-Filing", \Filing & Scrutiny", \Notice / Summons", \Evidence Stage", \Final Arguments", \Judgment Reserved", \Disposed").

3. Case Allocation Pipeline

3.1 Initial Assignment during Case Creation (\CreateCaseWizardModal.tsx)

When a new case is filed via the \Create Case Wizard\, the creator (Managing Partner or Clerk) selects the Lead Counsel from the firm's active member roster:

\\typescript

// CreateCaseWizardModal.tsx (Lines 328-342)

```
const [leadAdvocate, setLeadAdvocate] = useState(activeRoster[0]?.name || "");
```

// Automatic resolution of Lead Advocate

```
const newCasePayload = {
  name: caseTitle.trim(),
  clientName: clientName.trim(),
  caseType: selectedCaseType,
  courtName: courtName.trim(),
  leadAdvocate: leadAdvocate || ownerMember?.name,
  leadAdvocateUserId: selectedMember?.userId || ownerMember?.id,
  teamMembers: [leadAdvocate, ...selectedAssociateNames],
  workspaceId: activeWorkspaceId
};
```

\\\

3.2 Dynamic Case Team Management (\CaseTeamModal.tsx)

Once a case is created, partners can modify the assigned team at any time using the \CaseTeamModal:

- \Assign New Associates:\ Search firm members and add them as \Senior Advocate\, \Junior Advocate\, \Assigned Advocate\, \Researcher\, or \Paralegal.
- \Role Elevation:\ Promote an associate to Co-Counsel or Lead Advocate.
- \De-allocation:\ Safely remove a member who has concluded their phase of work on the file.

\\typescript

// CaseTeamModal.tsx (Lines 47-54)

```
const AVAILABLECASEROLES = [
  'Lead Advocate',
  'Senior Advocate',
  'Junior Advocate',
  'Assigned Advocate',
```

```
'Researcher',
'Paralegal'
];
\\
```

4. Lead Advocate Protection & Succession Engine

In litigation, a case cannot exist without an authorized legal representative. The system enforces \\Lead Advocate Protection Rules\\ at both the UI and API levels to prevent accidental disassociation:

```
\\mermaid
```

```
graph TD
```

```
Request[Action: Change Role or Remove Member from Case] --> CheckLead{Is Target Member currently Lead Advocate?}
```

```
CheckLead -- No --> AllowAction[Execute Role Change / Removal]
```

```
CheckLead -- Yes --> CheckActionType{Action Type}
```

```
CheckActionType -- Remove Member --> BlockRemove[BLOCK REMOVAL: 'Cannot remove Lead Advocate! Assign another Lead first.']
```

```
CheckActionType -- Role Downgrade --> PromptSuccessor[Prompt Managing Partner to Designate New Lead Advocate]
```

```
PromptSuccessor --> TransferSuccess[Update project.leadAdvocate & project.leadAdvocateUserId]
```

```
\\
```

```
### Backend Enforcement (\\routes/projectRoutes.js):
```

```
\\javascript
```

```
// Verification and safe lead transfer in projectRoutes.js (Lines 1738-1744 & 2139-2144)
```

```
if (newRole === 'Lead Advocate') {
```

```
  project.leadAdvocate = memberName.startsWith('Adv.') ? memberName : `Adv. ${memberName}`;
```

```
  project.leadAdvocateUserId = targetMemberId;
```

```
  await project.save();
```

```
}
```

```
// Protection rule preventing orphan cases
```

```
if (isCurrentLead && action === 'remove') {
```

```
  return res.status(400).json({
```

```
    success: false,
```

```
    error: 'A case must have an active Lead Advocate. Designate another Lead Advocate before removing this counsel.'
```

```
  });
```

```
}
```

```
\\
```

5. Collaborative Case Folders & Asset Isolation

When a case is opened, all assigned members gain access to a unified \\Collaborative Case Docket\\. All files created within this docket inherit the firm's security boundary:

```
\\
```

```
□ Case Docket: "M/s Skylark Logistics vs. State of Delhi" [DL/HC/10293/2026]
```

```
└─ □ Central Brief & Case Summary (Co-edited by Lead & Junior Advocates)
```

- └─ □ Drafts & Pleadings (Petitions, Interim Applications, Rejoinders)
 - | └─ "PlaintCommercialSuitv1.docx" [Drafted by Jr. Adv. Kunal]
 - | └─ "WrittenSubmissionsFinal.pdf" [Approved by Sr. Adv. Rajesh]
- └─ □ Evidentiary Exhibits & Annexures (Managed by Evidence Clerk)
 - | └─ "ExhibitP1Contract.pdf" [OCR Processed & Tagged]
 - | └─ "ExhibitP2BankStatements.xlsx" [Verified]
- └─ ✂ AI Strategy & Predictive Analysis (Shared across case team)
 - | └─ Precedent Analysis: Supreme Court bench judgments on Section 9 Arbitration
 - | └─ Win Probability & Risk Heatmap
- └─ □ Daily Court Hearings & Cause List Updates (Updated by Court Clerk)
 - | └─ 14-Oct-2026: Court No. 4, Item 18 (Pre-trial Arguments)
 - | └─ Order Sheet download & auto-indexing
- └─ □ Actionable Task Pipeline (Delegated assignments with deadlines)

\\

Access Control Verification (\services/taskAccessControl.service.js\ & \middleware/authorization.js):

\\javascript

// Strict tenant & case boundary verification

const canAccessCase =

req.user.role === 'admin' ||

workspace.ownerId.toString() === req.user.id ||

project.leadAdvocateUserId?.toString() === req.user.id ||

project.assignedUserIds.map(String).includes(req.user.id);

if (!canAccessCase) {

return res.status(403).json({ error: 'Access denied: You are not assigned to this case.' });

}

\\

6. Granular Task Delegation & Milestone Tracking

Partners and Lead Advocates do not merely assign whole cases; they delegate discrete, actionable deliverables with specific deadlines:

6.1 Task Delegation Lifecycle

1. \\Creation:\\ Lead Counsel assigns a task: \"Draft Section 11 Arbitration Application\" to Junior Associate Adv. Neha.

2. \\Context Binding:\\ The task is directly linked to the specific case project, pulling in relevant client documents automatically.

3. \\Status Progression:\\

- \\To Do\\ → \\In Progress\\ → \\Under Partner Review\\ → \\Completed.

4. \\Approval Gate:\\ When Adv. Neha marks the draft as ready, it enters the \\Partner Review Queue\\. The Lead Advocate can approve, request amendments with inline comments, or finalize for filing.

6.2 Task Access Control Logic

- \\Assignee:\\ Can update progress, upload draft attachments, and request clarifications.

- \\Lead Counsel / Partner:\\ Can reassign, adjust deadlines, approve drafts, or close the task.

- \\Paralegal / Support Staff:\\ Can attach registry receipts and court acknowledgment stamps.

7. Real-World Case Delegation Scenarios

Scenario A: High-Stakes Commercial Arbitration

- \\Managing Partner:\\ Oversees overall matter strategy and client communication.
- \\Lead Senior Counsel:\\ Formulates statement of claim and conducts oral arguments before the Sole Arbitrator.
- \\Associate Advocate:\\ Prepares cross-examination questions for claimant witnesses and files interim applications under Section 17.
- \\Legal Researcher:\\ Uses AI Precedent Finder to discover recent 3-judge bench rulings on patent illegality under Section 34.

Scenario B: Criminal Bail Hearing

- \\Lead Advocate:\\ Assigned to argue bail application before the Sessions Judge.
- \\Court Clerk:\\ Tracks daily cause list, verifies case item number, and confirms presence of public prosecutor.
- \\Evidence Clerk:\\ Cross-references case diary entries and FIR witness statements using AI Evidence Analyst.

8. Summary of API Endpoints for Case Delegation

\\ API Route | Method | Payload / Params | Purpose |

\\:---|:---|:---|:---|

\\ /api/projects\\ | \\POST\\ | \\{ name, leadAdvocate, leadAdvocateUserId, teamMembers, workspaceId }\\ | Creates a new case with explicit lead counsel and team allocation. |

\\ /api/projects/:id/team\\ | \\GET\\ | Case \\id\\ in path | Fetches full roster of assigned advocates, lead counsel, and unassigned members. |

\\ /api/projects/:id/assign-lead\\ | \\PUT\\ | \\{ newLeadUserId, newLeadName }\\ | Safely updates the lead counsel with complete audit logging. |

\\ /api/projects/:id/team/members\\ | \\POST\\ | \\{ userIds, roleInCase }\\ | Assigns additional associates or paralegals to the case team. |

\\ /api/projects/:id/team/members/:memberId\\ | \\DELETE\\ | Case \\id\\, \\memberId\\ in path | Removes an associate from the case docket (enforcing lead protection). |

\\ /api/projects/:id/tasks\\ | \\POST\\ | \\{ title, assignedToUserId, dueDate, priority }\\ | Creates and delegates a specific case action item. |